Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 18, 2026

Compiled summary for Sunday, October 18, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 16 interactive-philosophy record; verifying the current United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; transforming the landing-page UI / UX Philosophy presentation into selectable UI and UX carousel modes; creating five licensed gradient lock assets; preserving the five-step UI key system while adding an intentionally empty but navigable UX track; substantially enlarging and repositioning the animated five-point star; correcting clipping, layering, opacity, rotation, and active-tip color behavior; building joined U I and U X discipline controls with synchronized icons and stack-colored surfaces; cutting transparent key and lock silhouettes through the active star; revising the five UI principle messages; tightening carousel spacing and equalizing large-card geometry; validating TypeScript, local routes, and repository synchronization; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 18 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, implementation sections grouped by feature, committed-source sequence, validation summary, files-and-artifacts list, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. This record describes completed work and repository evidence rather than proposed visual directions.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october16.pdf and documentation commit 063c259. Two October 18 implementation commits are included: ee3023bbb341c0e6db4f04f97599f5ed461ef3ef and 5c733bc31e3f9cb00a0c5f13b14a878eaa75f90d. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 5c733bc. No Hostinger deploy-branch update, GitHub Actions dispatch, public-site publish, production deployment, external message, or additional source commit was performed during this documentation pass. The new documentation deltas are the reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this PDF.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: ran a timezone-specific America/New_York check immediately before generation. It reported Sunday, October 18, 2026 at 10:53 PM EDT with a UTC-04:00 offset. October 18 remains within United States Eastern Daylight Time, so this artifact uses October 18 rather than a host-default or UTC calendar date.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio before composing this record. It refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt to 21,083 lines and 704,531 bytes, capturing current application source, assets, worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, Git context, and the standing instruction to request a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 56 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_october16.pdf. The archive contained 315 pages and approximately 161,923 extracted words before this artifact.
- Archive comparison: studied the full extracted corpus for filename cadence, same-day Part suffix rules, title construction, opening-summary density, baseline and goal framing, technical bullet voice, commit and deployment disclosure, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, and output-artifact closure.
- Nearest baselines: read the complete October 16 record as the immediate source and design baseline, then compared all October records and representative July through September entries to preserve the mature compact format rather than treating the newest document in isolation.
- PDF conventions: checked pdfinfo, pdffonts, extracted bounding boxes, and a rasterized October 16 first page. The mature format remains US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, no encryption, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 text, dense black-on-white copy, compact margins, a single first-page title, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Git evidence: reviewed both October 18 commit bodies, statistics, full source diffs, tracked assets, branch refs, and the aggregate delta since the October 16 documentation commit. The completed change set spans thirteen tracked files with 1,121 insertions and 187 deletions, including the updated component, shared CSS, landing copy, project snapshot, license record, five lock SVGs, and three key/lock mask or outline SVGs.
- Runtime evidence: reviewed the live Next.js source and local preview, confirmed the primary routes, and compared final CSS values against the user-directed visual sequence, including cases where stale Turbopack output had previously made correct source appear unchanged.

Baseline Status Before October 18

- The October 16 state already provided five UI philosophy stacks, three numbered detail selectors per stack, detail-specific Alla Vostra and Cinerific media, device-frame variants, right-aligned project labels, and a protected bottom anchor for populated screenshots.
- The compact desktop carousel still represented only one discipline. Its active star carried a colored key, the top controls did not distinguish Interface Design from User Experience, and selecting another discipline could not reset the carousel to a predictable starting stack.
- No UX-specific carousel track existed. There were no five-color lock assets, no lock licensing record, no lock-only active-point icon system, and no intentionally blank UX large-card content states that retained numbered navigation.
- The star was comparatively small and positioned above the numbered surface. Its geometry did not yet pass behind the top controls and carousel surfaces, its muted lower shape remained too visible, and canvas/drop-shadow edges could read as an unwanted black square or invisible clipping wall.
- The number box, title bridge, carousel arrows, star, icon, and future discipline controls had not been balanced as one vertical composition. Several iterative scale changes risked icon-to-box overlap, uneven gaps, or inconsistent placement between keys and locks.
- The five UI messages still used Streamlined, Digestible, Butter-Smooth, Interwoven / Interconnected, and Cross-Format / Cross-Device language. The requested shorter phrasing and two-sentence first-row treatment had not been applied.

Goals for October 18

- Create clear, actionable UI and UX modes without replacing the existing five-step carousel, spring rotation, arrow controls, hold behavior, keyboard semantics, reduced-motion support, or responsive component structure.
- Keep the UI mode attached to the five existing keys and populated philosophy cards, while giving UX its own five matching locks, numbered 01 through 05 navigation, and deliberately empty headers, imagery, supporting copy, and large-card contents until future UX material is authored.
- Make either discipline selector return its target carousel to Stack 01 when switching from the other mode, preserving the shortest rotational path and the existing staged animation behavior.
- Enlarge and lower the five-point star, remove clipping and square-edge artifacts, keep it behind content surfaces where requested, preserve exact active-tip rotation behavior, and establish a controlled top-to-bottom visibility fade.
- Use the five key gradient families consistently across locks, star tips, number and header surfaces, and selector controls while keeping icon cavities transparent, active-point symbols legible, and inactive controls intentionally inconspicuous.

- Tighten the overall vertical rhythm: join the discipline buttons, balance icon and number-to-arrow spacing, protect the large-card contents, and give all five primary boxes one shorter equal height.
- Revise the landing copy and subtitle to communicate the relationship between interface design keys and user-experience lock-in more directly.

Work Completed - Selectable UI and UX Carousel Modes

- Added selectedDiscipline state and a U I / U X control group above the compact three-dimensional carousel. Both options are semantic buttons with aria-pressed state, keyboard focus treatment, and pointer behavior independent of the carousel faces.
- Implemented selectDisciplineAtFirstStack so clicking or tapping either mode selects that discipline and returns the focused decision to 01. The routine clears hold timers, computes the shorter circular distance to the first stack, updates the star rotation by the same delta, and stages the carousel move through the existing transition system.
- Preserved the original UI content path: UI mode continues to show the five existing philosophy headers, detail selectors, project imagery, device frames, supporting context, and populated large boxes.
- Added an isUxMode rendering path that retains all five 01 through 05 carousel positions, arrow navigation, selected number, active star point, and large-card shell while suppressing UI-specific title bridges, headlines, detail controls, device imagery, labels, descriptions, and decorative noodles.
- Kept the UX large cards intentionally empty rather than inserting placeholder prose. Their equal physical boxes and numbered navigation make the interaction complete now while reserving all future content slots for authored UX flow material.
- Maintained the existing previous/next click, tap, pointer-hold, wraparound, spring rotation, staged face transition, and reduced-motion behavior across both disciplines.

Work Completed - Five-Color Lock Asset System

- Created philosophy-lock-01.svg through philosophy-lock-05.svg and mapped them to the purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green decision numbers. Each asset uses the same endpoint colors and visual family as its corresponding key.
- Based the lock geometry on Lucide's reusable lock-keyhole icon and added LOCK_ICON_LICENSE.txt with the source URL and ISC license text. The work therefore records the external geometry origin and reuse terms inside the asset directory.
- Rebuilt the lock marks with transparent negative space and black inner and outer strokes around filled regions, then iterated body width, body height, shackle height, hole diameter, and vertical placement to sit naturally within the star tips without clipping colored assets.
- Moved from an initially key-width body toward the midpoint between the original lock width and the corresponding key width, compressed the body vertically by twenty percent, reduced the shackle height, and re-centered the circular cavity after each geometry change.
- Adjusted the lock hole several times against the key's circular opening, rejecting both the undersized and oversized extremes before settling on the final visual relationship.
- Added reusable UiUxActiveLock rendering plus philosophy-lock-outline.svg for the active star cutout treatment. The component selects the correct gradient lock by decision number and uses the outline asset when the star needs a transparent rather than filled symbol.

Work Completed - Star Scale, Motion, Masking, and Active Tips

- Expanded the star from the earlier compact treatment to a composition approximately 6.1 times the number-surface dimension, then moved it downward behind the controls and card surfaces so the upward point remains the primary visible anchor.
- Re-centered the animated star on the numbered box, removed the inherited drop shadow, and added controlled inset clipping at the mask and image layers. These changes eliminated the black canvas-like square and the invisible wall that had clipped the middle and lower points.
- Preserved the five-tip spring animation, 72-degree step sequence, and 144-degree initial orientation. Added a one-degree clockwise settle correction only to yellow and green, leaving purple, blue, and orange at their exact prior settle rotations.
- Established the accepted vertical alpha profile: 80 percent through 25.1 percent of the star, 50 percent at 27 percent, 15 percent at 29.1 percent, 5 percent at 38.2 percent, and 0 percent at 48.2 percent through the bottom. Closely spaced stops around the triangle-button height slow the visible falloff before the lower region disappears.
- Added per-tip active clipping polygons so the upward-facing point fills with its own natural gradient rather than exposing a flat dark hollow. Layered radial sheen, diagonal highlight, and subtle vertical shading over the fill for a more dynamic surface.
- Reduced excessive endpoint contrast with per-color brightness, saturation, and contrast filters. Purple, orange, and green receive a slightly brighter low endpoint, while yellow and blue retain their approved balance.
- Created philosophy-key-mask.svg and philosophy-lock-mask.svg, then composed each with the star's vertical alpha mask. The active key or lock now punctures through the colored point to the landing-page background while a separate white outline remains above the star.
- Kept the symbol at a higher visual depth than the active star point, enlarged final white-outline keys and locks by twenty-five percent, and centered them between the joined discipline controls and the numbered surface without crossing the number box.

Work Completed - Discipline Controls and Surface Hierarchy

- Joined the U I and U X buttons at the horizontal center with no inter-button gap and matched their combined width to the forward-facing carousel stack. The labels retain explicit letter spacing while the original Principles / Form and Flow experiments were removed.
- Placed the selector pair in front of the enlarged star in the final accepted depth order. Both controls retain the current decision's color family, stack fill language, and border family so changing from 01 to 05 updates the pair with the active carousel tone.
- Matched each button icon to the key or lock shown at the active star point. Both icons remain present, including the inactive discipline, and use the same decision-specific gradient source before state styling is applied.
- Made the selected button the legible primary surface with white text, stronger fill, and the active icon treatment. Matched its dark translucent fill to the accepted 75-percent number and title-box opacity rather than returning to a fully opaque white surface.
- Reduced the inactive button to a transparent landing-page surface with a standard stronger line, no colored fill, and outline-only text and icon rendering. Replaced the artifact-prone text stroke experiment with an SVG morphology/composite outline filter and then reduced its thickness for cleaner U X diagonals and curved U forms.
- Raised and spread the original controls away from the star, then rejoined and widened them after the labels were simplified to U I and U X. Final spacing protects the section heading and subtitle while keeping the selector pair visually attached to the carousel.
- Kept number and title surfaces translucent enough for the star to remain faintly visible through them, but increased their fill to the accepted 75-percent level so text remains dominant. Borders and per-tone surface accents continue to track the current stack.

- Rebalanced the key/lock, number box, and triangle-button gaps by direct visual tuning after computed symmetry alone did not match the screenshot. The final top icon sits between the discipline row and number surface, while arrow controls flank the number without touching the star or box.

Work Completed - Large Cards, Copy, and Content Placement

- Reduced the focused large-card height from 692.484 pixels to 644.484 pixels and applied the same value across all five UI stacks. This removed awkward unused space at the lower edge without creating different card heights.
- Moved detail selectors and the principal text/media composition upward inside the large boxes, changed the shared device bottom anchor from 64 pixels to 40 pixels, and protected screenshots and supporting assets from clipping during the height reduction.
- Updated the section subtitle to 5 'Keys' to User Interface Design That 'Lock' In the User Experience, making the two discipline modes and their key/lock metaphor explicit before interaction begins.
- Revised Stack 01 from Sleek / Streamlined to Sleek / Polished while preserving NEVER / Last Year. and its Modern title.
- Revised Stack 02 from Intuitive / Digestible / EASY / To Grasp to Intuitive / Clear / EASY / To-Grasp. The final form uses a hyphen between To and Grasp and no decorative underscore after EASY.
- Revised Stack 03 from Instant / Butter-Smooth to Instant / Smooth while preserving SAFELY / Satisfying. The change applies only to the Stack 03 large box.
- Revised Stack 04 from Interwoven / Interconnected to Sound / Sensible while preserving ALWAYS / Congruent.
- Revised Stack 05 through several cross-format experiments and settled on X-Form. / X-Device. / ALWAYS / Adaptable., including the requested periods and two concise first-row sentences.
- Adjusted the headline layout so the paired opening statements can share the intended first visual row before wrapping, while keeping the emphasis words, device media, and supporting assets in their protected zones.

Work Completed - Cache Recovery and Iterative Review

- Kept the local development preview available at http://localhost:3000 throughout the UI / UX iteration sequence.
- When visible output remained unchanged despite correct component or CSS edits, stopped the exact running process, moved generated .next output into recoverable .next.cleared-* folders, and restarted Next.js from a clean development cache.
- Used the clean-cache result to distinguish stale Turbopack output from actual star-scale, spacing, opacity, and selector-state defects before making further source edits.
- Preserved all source files, design assets, worklogs, and user data during cache recovery. The retained cache folders remain recoverable and were not deleted during this record.

Committed Source Sequence

- ee3023b - Refined the UI/UX philosophy carousel with selectable UI and UX modes. Added actionable discipline selectors, five licensed gradient lock assets, navigable blank UX stacks, enlarged and rotationally tuned the star, refined key/lock geometry, and updated the section subtitle and snapshot.
- 5c733bc - Refined the UI/UX philosophy carousel and landing-page presentation. Completed reset-to-01 discipline switching, active-point fills and masks, transparent white-outlined key/lock cutouts, selector and surface hierarchy, equal-card sizing, copy revisions, and final asset placement.
- The aggregate completed source delta after documentation commit 063c259 spans app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, LOCK_ICON_LICENSE.txt, five colored lock SVGs, and three key/lock mask or outline SVGs.
- At documentation time, HEAD, local main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 5c733bc31e3f9cb00a0c5f13b14a878eaa75f90d. The source work is committed and synchronized; this PDF-generation pass did not create another commit or push.

Validation Summary

- npm run check completed successfully with tsc --noEmit against the synchronized October 18 source.
- Local HTTP checks returned 200 for /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles while the development server remained available.
- Source review confirmed five decision-number lock mappings, two semantic discipline buttons, aria-pressed state, reset-to-first-stack logic, shortest-path rotation selection, and preserved carousel hold timers and staged action behavior.
- CSS review confirmed the final 80 / 50 / 15 / 5 / 0 star mask sequence, one-degree yellow and green settle offsets, active-tip polygons for all five colors, removed star drop shadow, corrected clip boundaries, and white key/lock outline layers above the star.
- Layout review confirmed the selector pair is joined and centered, combined to the active stack width, placed above the star in final depth order, and styled with a selected 75-percent dark surface plus an intentionally low-emphasis transparent inactive state.
- Content review confirmed all five final descriptions, the revised subtitle, empty UX content regions, numbered UX navigation, equal 644.484-pixel large-card heights, raised internal assets, and protected device placement.
- License review confirmed the lock asset directory contains the Lucide source URL, ISC permission notice, and warranty disclaimer.
- Repository review confirmed the application source is clean, the implementation commits are synchronized, and only the customary regenerated snapshot plus this generated worklog remain as local documentation changes after PDF creation.
- No static export or production deployment was run because the requested outcome was the customary PDF worklog, not a publish or release pass.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - discipline state and buttons, reset-to-first-stack navigation, UI/UX conditional rendering, key and lock components, lock asset mapping, transparent cutout behavior, per-tip settle offsets, and retained carousel interaction semantics.
- app/globals.css - enlarged star geometry, vertical alpha mask, active-tip fill layers, clipping fixes, key/lock masks, icon placement, selector surfaces, inactive outline filter, carousel spacing, surface opacity, equal large-card height, and raised content anchors.
- app/page.tsx - revised philosophy subtitle and final five UI principle descriptions.
- public/images/uiux/LOCK_ICON_LICENSE.txt - Lucide lock-keyhole attribution and ISC license text.
- public/images/uiux/philosophy-lock-01.svg through philosophy-lock-05.svg - five decision-matched gradient lock assets with transparent cavities and black structural strokes.
- public/images/uiux/philosophy-key-mask.svg, philosophy-lock-mask.svg, and philosophy-lock-outline.svg - star cutout masks and white-outline lock presentation support.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed project-reader output generated before this documentation artifact.
- portfolio_worklog_october18.pdf - new requested worklog generated by this pass.

Follow-Up Notes

- Keep discipline switching anchored to Stack 01 unless a future UX information architecture requires independent remembered positions. The current reset gives every mode change a predictable entrance and synchronized star rotation.
- UX cards are intentionally blank beyond 01 through 05. Add future UX headers, imagery, and copy through a discipline-specific data model rather than allowing the UI detailScreenshots fallback to populate them accidentally.
- Preserve the lock license file with the five derived SVGs. If their geometry is substantially replaced, update the attribution only after confirming the new source and terms.
- Treat the star as three coordinated systems: spring rotation, per-tip active fill, and vertical visibility mask. Scale or position changes should be checked against all three plus the key/lock subtraction masks.
- Keep yellow and green at their one-degree settle corrections and leave purple, blue, and orange unchanged unless a new star raster changes the apparent geometry.
- Maintain the current depth order: star behind the discipline, number, title, and content surfaces; white-outlined key or lock above the active star point; selectors in front for reliable interaction.
- Preserve the selected/inactive discipline contrast without restoring artifact-prone text strokes. The inactive morphology outline is shared by text and icon presentation and should be tested around the U X intersection after filter changes.
- When visible development output disagrees with authored CSS, inspect the served bundle and recover generated .next state before compensating around stale output.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october18.pdf using the established lowercase-month, non-zero-padded-day root-level naming convention.
- The title and filename use Sunday, October 18, 2026 after explicit America/New_York verification at UTC-04:00.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex metadata consistent with the mature archive.
- The recorded synchronized application baseline is 5c733bc31e3f9cb00a0c5f13b14a878eaa75f90d. No production deployment, remote branch mutation, public publish, or external communication was performed during generation.
- Documentation deltas created by this pass are portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_october18.pdf. No application source was edited while producing the worklog.